

KUWAIT

LAND AREA 17,818 SQ. KM	**POPULATION** 4.9 MILLION
INDIAN EXPATRIATES 1.04 MILLION (31% of expats in Kuwait)	**REMITTANCES TO INDIA** $4.6 BILLION (3.9% of total inflows)
GDP $160.2 BILLION	**OIL RENTS*** 27.6%

THE DAMAGE

NO. OF MISSILE/ DRONE ATTACKS 1,100+	**KILLED/ WOUNDED** 7/ 100
DROP IN OIL EXPORTS 98%	**GDP GROWTH DOWNGRADE** 9 % POINTS

KEY FACILITIES HIT

● Kuwait airport ● Camp Buehring ● Ali Al Salem airbase ● Kuwait Petroleum Corp refineries ● desalination plants ● Shuwaikh oil sector complex ● Mina al-Ahmadi refinery

*economic surplus generated from oil production, as % of GDP

"THE SITUATION IS MARKED BY UNPREDICTABILITY. EVEN TRUMP HAS ACKNOWLEDGED IT, BUT CALLS IT A MASTER STRATEGY. TO ME, IT APPEARS LIKE A MASTER FOLLY"

Q. Why do you call Trump's strategy a master folly?
Because there is no clear, consistent objective. If you look at Israel, their objective is clear—they aim for regime disruption or change and to reshape the regional balance. But the US position has kept shifting. At first, it was about nuclear weapons. Then missiles were added. Then naval concerns. Then regime change. Then a retreat from that position. And then again, a return to nuclear concerns. War is not just about tactics—it requires a coherent strategy with a defined end goal. Even if the US claims success in damaging nuclear facilities, questions remain, such as the whereabouts of the enriched uranium. Meanwhile, Iran is calling not just for a ceasefire but for a permanent cessation, which requires deeper negotiations involving both regional and global actors. That impulse—seeking a long-term resolution—is the right one. We cannot continue with cycles of conflict.

Q. What would be an acceptable resolution to the conflict for Kuwait?
Kuwait understands its position as a small state in a difficult neighbourhood. Our guiding principle has always been de-escalation, peace and stability. We have experienced war repeatedly, so we know its cost. That is why any resolution must address root causes—not just freeze the situation temporarily. We need a 360-degree approach. This means understanding how Iran sees the world and, equally, ensuring they understand our perspective. Only through that mutual understanding can real compromises emerge.

There are key issues that must be addressed. These are: Iran's involvement in the internal affairs of neighbouring states through proxies or militias. Then the need to ensure the civilian nature of nuclear programmes across the region. There should be transparency from all nuclear-capable states, including Israel. And we must ensure freedom of navigation, which has been threatened during this conflict. These are not minor issues—they go to the heart of regional stability. Ultimately, we need to move toward a new security architecture. This will not happen overnight, but it must begin with honest identification of problems, even if different countries define them differently. Only then can progress be made.

Q. What might this "new security architecture" that you talk about look like?
We are not looking to overturn existing partnerships overnight. That is not how Gulf states operate. The US remains an important partner, but there is a distinction between defence partnerships and security guarantees. The latter have become less reliable over time. Since the Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action (JCPOA) under President Obama to more recent incidents, there has been a perception of gaps in security guarantees.

This means two things: First, we need to diversify partnerships. Second, and more importantly, we need to build our own defence capabilities. There are strong examples in the region—Turkey, Iran, India, Pakistan—all developing indigenous defence industries. Warfare itself is evolving, and we must adapt. We are already seeing moves in this direction, especially by countries like the UAE and Saudi Arabia, which are investing heavily in local defence production. The Gulf has significant financial resources, including some of the world's largest sovereign wealth funds. If these are directed toward advanced technologies—AI, defence systems and innovation—there is no reason why a substantial portion of capability cannot be developed locally. Self-sufficiency is ultimately the most reliable form of security. ■